



INDIAN ACCENT

For many Indian brands, the diaspora plays a very important role in spreading the message

1. Amrapali
showroom in
Mumbai

2. Kama Ayurveda
showroom at
Harrods, London



Rahul feels craftsmanship alone isn't enough because "every second outfit showcased at couture shows is made in India. Storytelling is important". For an international audience, appeal goes beyond just exporting craft. "It is about exporting an evolved idea of Indian luxury that is avant-garde, global, and future-facing," says Gupta.

Tarang of Amrapali highlights the dependence on the diaspora since it appreciates Indian craftsmanship more than people of other nationalities. "They understand the traditional parts and want to reconnect with their origin through jewellery, especially during special occasions."

Paris-based Indian designer Mohanjeet Grewal, who set up her store at the city's Rue de Bac in 1964, is elated to see that India is acknowledged on global platforms. However, she stresses that brands must harp on their 'Indian-ness', "Brands branching out of India must become an entity on their own, so they continue after."

Indian luxury labels are well aware of this, and brands like Rahul Mishra "look to carry forward the legacy through textiles, embroidery, and handwork". Though proud of their origin, homegrown designers have realised the key to world domination is blending Indian craft with international sensibilities. Gupta sums it up, adding that his mission is to present Indian couture as futuristic and subversive. "I want to show that Indian couture can sit next to Balenciaga or Schiaparelli and hold its own." **BT**

(With inputs from Sakshi Batra)